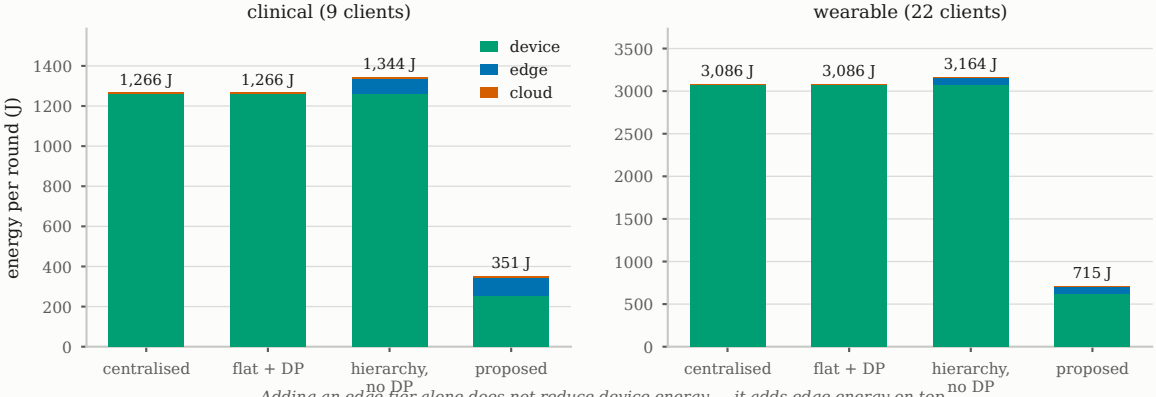

Adding an edge tier alone does not reduce device energy — it adds edge energy on top. Only the proposed configuration, which also shortens what each device computes and sends, reduces the constrained tier.